

DYNAMIC TEEN COALITION

Youth Policy Lab

*Putting teens at the table.
Not just on the agenda.*

INNOSpark Pitch Competition — April 2026



THE PROBLEM

42

countries have enacted or proposed social media bans or blanket restrictions targeting minors

0%

of those bans were developed with meaningful youth consultation or participation

100%

of teens are subject to these laws — including those who rely on social media for survival

Governments are passing sweeping age-based restrictions on internet access — banning teenagers from platforms, restricting their online lives — without consulting the people most affected. These are blunt, policy-first interventions with serious unintended consequences for vulnerable youth.

Blanket restrictions don't protect teens. They abandon them.

WHO BLANKET RESTRICTIONS HURT MOST

LGBTQ+ Youth

For many queer teens, social media is their only access to community, affirmation, and crisis resources — particularly in unsupportive homes or conservative regions.

Youth in Crisis

Teens using platforms for venting their trauma and mental health situation will lose access to these means of expressions.

Low-Income Students

Platforms are the primary education and networking infrastructure for youth without access to elite institutions or paid opportunities.

Youth in All Contexts

From Australia to the UK to sub-Saharan Africa, restrictions play out differently — but the exclusion of youth voices from the process is universal.

These groups need more online access — not less. Blanket bans make their lives more dangerous.

OUR HISTORY

2022

Ethiopia IGF — Founded

Invited by the UN IGF Secretariat to establish the Dynamic Teen Coalition — the first teen-led coalition at the Internet Governance Forum.

2023–24

UN Advocacy & Research

Attended UN Events, challenged social media bans globally, began building the first systematic global database of teen online restrictions.

2025

Oslo — The Confrontation

At IGF2025, Norway: confronted Australia's Ambassador for Cyber Affairs Brendan Dowling on the teen ban's impact on marginalized youth. That exchange became our paper.

2026

Policy Lab Launches

DTC evolves into a full policy research lab. Paper under review at Taylor & Francis. Recruiting paid teen researchers globally.



THE SOLUTION: A YOUTH-LED POLICY RESEARCH LAB

We embed paid teen researchers into the policy pipeline — producing IRB-approved, peer-reviewable research that makes it impossible for governments to legislate youth without youth.

01

Recruit Teen Researchers

7–10 paid high school researchers (\$50–75 each) recruited globally via LinkedIn. They pick topics within digital youth policy, or we assign one — but they lead it.

02

Run Rigorous Research

IRB-approved methodology: surveys, content analysis of public forums, focus groups. Emphasis on blanket restrictions and their real-world impact on youth.

03

Publish & Advocate

Open-access journals + peer-reviewed submissions. Journalist outreach to EFF, NYT, regional outlets. Data brought to HLPF 2026 and ECOSOC 2027.

Not another youth advisory panel. Real research. Real impact. Real paychecks.

WHAT WE'VE ALREADY BUILT

Before a single INNOSpark dollar — here is the body of work the Dynamic Teen Coalition has produced:

1 Global Teen Restriction Database

The first systematic effort to map social media bans and blanket restrictions affecting teens across countries and platforms — built for policy and advocacy use.

2

Paper: Blanket Restrictions & Marginalized Youth

Original research on the real-world impacts of age-based platform bans on vulnerable youth. Currently under peer review at the Taylor & Francis Social Sciences journal.

3

UN Website Ageism Audit

Identification of discriminatory access patterns across UN and UN-affiliated websites, plus initiation of a UN-wide ageism study using automation-assisted methods.

4

Opportunity-Mapping Database

A structured database separating under-18 and 18+ access pathways across global platforms and institutions — making youth-accessible opportunities discoverable.

All of this was built by teenagers, voluntarily, at the United Nations level. Imagine what we can do funded.

WHY WE'RE DIFFERENT

✗ What exists today

- Adults writing laws about teens, for teens, without teens
- Youth policy 'panels' that produce zero binding outcomes
- Research on youth conducted by academics who aren't youth
- Academic findings locked behind paywalls — invisible to policymakers

✓ Dynamic Teen Coalition

- ★ Teen researchers leading — design, execution, publication
- ★ We ARE the demographic. We know the culture, the stakes, the platforms
- ★ IRB-approved research already under peer review at Taylor & Francis
- ★ Open-access first — findings go to journalists, policymakers, the public

TRACTION



What we've delivered:

- Attended multiple UN sessions including Ethiopia IGF 2022 and IGF 2025 Oslo
- Confronted Australia's Ambassador for Cyber Affairs at IGF2025 — exchange became the basis of our paper
- Paper currently under peer review at Taylor & Francis Social Sciences journal
- Built the world's first global database mapping teen social media restrictions by country and platform
- Completed UN website ageism audit; initiated automation-assisted UN-wide ageism study
- Built opportunity-mapping database separating under-18 / 18+ access pathways globally
- Attended UNGA; established DTC as a credible youth voice in global digital policy

ROADMAP TO IMPACT

Now → May 15

Recruit

Source 7–10 paid teen researchers via LinkedIn & network

June – July

IRB Approval

Ethics board review; methodology finalized; instruments built

Oct – Nov '26

Open Publish

Open-access + journalist outreach (EFF, NYT, TPP)

May 20–22

Select + Topics

Choose researchers, finalize research questions, begin IRB

July – Aug

Data Collection

Surveys, public forum analysis, focus groups

Mar – Apr '27

Peer Review

Peer-reviewed journal submissions; ECOSOC prep

ALREADY IN PROGRESS: Paper under peer review at Taylor & Francis Social Sciences journal

END GOAL: Present at HLPF July 2026 & ECOSOC Youth Forum 2027

WHAT WE'RE ASKING FOR

We are a 3-year-old organization with real deliverables at the UN level and a paper under peer review. Here's how you can accelerate us:



Funding

Directly funds researcher stipends (\$50–75 each), IRB fees, and open-access publishing costs. Every dollar goes to teen researchers.



Mentorship

We need guidance from legal/IRB experts, policymakers, and academics who understand how to navigate UN submissions and peer-review processes.

**The laws that
govern our online
lives are written
without us.**

*It's time teens stopped being
the subject of the research
and became the researchers.*